



Meet the Glif

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Netgear talks networking trends

A leader among consumer networking solution providers, Netgear's a household name anyone who's ever tried to buy a wireless router. We caught up with Richard Jonker, their VP for Emerging Markets (which includes India), to get a sense of what's happening in the world of networking, and India's place in it all. Excerpts from our exclusive interview:

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Tell us a bit about Netgear and your role in it.

Netgear is an American global technology company based in Silicon Valley. I run the part we call the emerging markets, a collective term for the fastest growing countries around the world. Among these new markets, India is one of the most interesting ones I would say. Netgear's split in three business divisions: Commercial, Consumer and Service Provider business. And I run the business under all three verticals in the countries that are under my purview.

What are your thoughts on India and the wireless broadband wave?

Today you can see that almost all the information that people possess, everything that people do is moving to the internet. So it's a new wave and there are couple of trends going on that I would like to talk to you about. Particularly here in India where things tend to go faster than other countries, you won't expect that but it's the reality. This is my fourth time in Mumbai, I can see things change, I can see the smartphone explosion, and how fast that goes here. I think Indian people are very tech savvy, very technology focused. And the trends here in India are similar to other countries. But it's more massive, because of all the number of people that are connecting to the Internet. That's possible because there is a healthy situation here with multiple carriers that are competing, and competition brings innovation. So the rollout of wireless mobile broadband for example is extremely fast here, as the adoption is there.



Richard Jonker, VP, Emerging Markets, Netgear

Any particular networking trends that you've observed here or globally?

So roughly the trends that we saw started to emerge couple of years ago, but they are really exploding, is the fact that people want to access any information they have – could be home, pictures, data or stuff from there work – on any screen at any place at any time. And that has driven a massive technology change. The fact that it became available at lower cost means it drives lots of innovation. So I think the big vehicle here is anything cloud, the fact that you don't have stuff on your local premises any more, it moves to the internet.

So we find that there is a hybrid model possible and that's the trend going forward. For example, you store the stuff that's important to you, your picture, videos, etc you store in local storage but you want to enable yourself to share that over the cloud, and you want to do both. you want to backup your data in such a

way that you can retrieve it but you don't want to keep it at home, because while you're travelling you want to access your data, pictures, music, videos over the cloud, but in such a way that it doesn't matter where you are any more, or whether you use a laptop or desktop or tablets. So that's really where we're driving at, so lot of our engineering efforts go into making that seamless experience possible – but without a lock-in model like Apple. We want to make sure that people can access in any data, so we plug into the the technologies that are upcoming at the moment, that has to do with cloud. One of the technologies that makes possible for you to access data or content everywhere would be mobile broadband which adopts quicker in India because of the investment – putting fibre in grounds to half a billion households is not going to happen in India. It has to go over the air, that's why the investments are here, that's why it's great that telecom companies are investing heavily in mobile infrastructure.

How's the router influencing any of these trends?

Wireless networking for a home is becoming faster than wired networking and this is a major trend, because for years wireless has been lagging to gigabit networks and now with Wireless 802.11ac what you have to do almost do 2 gigabit of throughput through a wireless router, which is massive. Also, we have a brutal dual core processor in all our routers with clocks higher than 1 GHz, which allows us to run applications on a router and that's another trend we see, that the router's going to be the enabling factor for cloud and smart home, and that's another trend. The smart home, powered by mobility and cloud. **T**